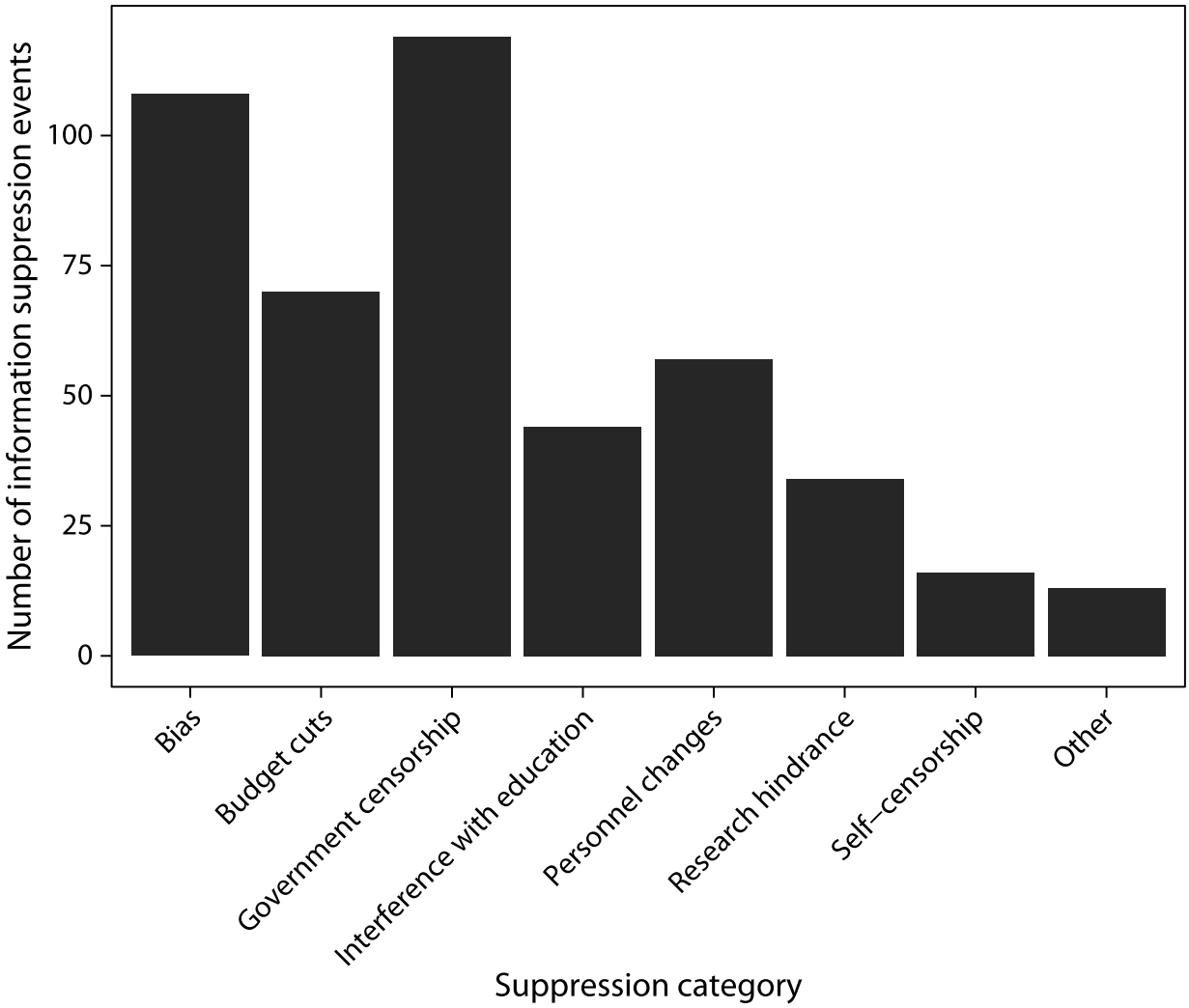


FIGURE 4.7. US information suppression events by category, 2017–2019. Data come from Silencing Science Tracker.

Our analysis of data from the World Development Indicators further corroborates these findings. The share of missing US data in the WDI dataset—a proxy for transparency and information sharing (Hollyer, Rosendorff, and Vreeland 2014)—rose steeply from under 20 percent in 2015 to nearly 60 percent by 2019 (figure 4.8). This dramatic increase suggests a systemic effort to curtail data sharing, consistent with Trump's populist orientation and skepticism toward IOs.

These trends are not unique to the United States. A similar pattern emerged in Turkey following the election of populist leader Recep Tayyip Erdoğan in 2014. As shown in figure 4.9, Turkey also exhibited a significant